

Healey takes aim at shelter guarantee

Calls for changes in law to tighten up the system

By Matt Stout
and Emma Platoff

GLOBE STAFF

Governor Maura Healey on Wednesday proposed foundational changes that would upend the state's unique right-to-shelter law, including adding a form of residency requirement that could make newly arrived migrants, whose numbers have swamped the system, no longer eligible for beds.

The proposals, if adopted by the Legislature, would dramatically rewrite the law that guarantees homeless families and pregnant women shelter. Healey unveiled the requests in a letter — but not actual legislation — she sent to the Legislature's Democratic leaders one day before she is slated to deliver her annual State of the Commonwealth address.

“My proposed changes will allow us to continue to ensure the safety of our system, support cities and towns in addressing the needs of unhoused families in their communities and put us on the path toward a more fiscally sustainable” program, Healey wrote in her letter.

Healey, a first-term Democrat, said last week that she was open to rewriting the shelter law, which the state adopted 40 years ago and requires it to provide shelter for homeless families. It's the only statewide law of its kind in the country, but Healey said the measure's “original intent” was not to cover the “waves and waves of people,” including migrant families, who

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Pam Bondi, President-elect Donald Trump's pick for attorney general, refused to explicitly say she would defy White House pressure during a confirmation hearing that repeatedly turned heated. Senator Marco Rubio, the choice for secretary of state, struck a moderate tone at his hearing. **A2.**

Opponents of the Wu administration's redevelopment of White Stadium fought back by pitching a much less expensive alternative for the Franklin Park sports facility. **D1.**

Federal officials are scrapping a proposed speed limit for ships around Cape Cod and the Islands that was intended to protect whales but would have eliminated fast-ferry service for key parts of the year. **B1.**

Chilly power

Thursday: Cool, clouding up. High 29-34. Low 21-26.

Friday: Sunny, not as cold. High 34-39. Low 25-30.

High tide: 12:38 a.m., 12:45 p.m.
Sunrise: 7:10 Sunset: 4:38

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Cease-fire deal brings hope

As he caps 50 years of service, Biden warns of ‘oligarchy’ of the ultrawealthy

Takes effect Sunday if Israeli Cabinet OK's it; Hamas sees ‘historic moment’



BASHAR TALEB/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

As news of the cease-fire deal spread Wednesday, celebrations began in the Gaza Strip, this one on a street in Khan Yunis.

By Erica L. Green

NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — As he and President-elect Donald Trump publicly claimed credit for the breakthrough in the Mideast, President Biden on Wednesday warned that an “oligarchy” of the ultrawealthy is emerging in the United States, sounding the alarm about unchecked power as he gave a farewell speech to the nation just days before he surrenders office to a man he disdains.

In an address from the Oval Office, Biden expressed concern about the “dangerous concentration of power” and issued a plea for the preservation of democratic ideals and institutions under the administration of Trump.

“Today, an oligarchy is taking shape in America of extreme wealth, power, and influence that literally threatens our entire democracy, our basic rights and freedoms, and a fair shot for everyone to get ahead,” Biden said.

While Biden did not explicitly name Trump, his remarks went straight at the tension at the heart of the incoming administration, in which billionaires like Elon Musk are positioned to wield enormous influence over the next four years. Are they really populists intent on shaking up the

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THREE STEPS TO AN END OF WAR

Phase 1

Hamas will release 33 hostages, Israel will release hundreds of Palestinian prisoners

Phase 2

After 42 days, if the two sides declare a “sustainable calm,” then Hamas will free the remaining male hostages, Israel will release additional prisoners and withdraw from Gaza

Phase 3

The two sides will exchange bodies of hostages and fighters, Gaza border will reopen, and a rebuilding plan implemented



AMIR LEVY/GETTY IMAGES

In Tel Aviv, emotions ran high at a rally calling for the return of the hostages.

By Adam Rasgon, Patrick Kingsley, Aaron Boxerman, Ronen Bergman, Peter Baker, and Isabel Kershner

NEW YORK TIMES

JERUSALEM — Negotiators announced Wednesday that they had reached a cease-fire deal for the war in the Gaza Strip, 15 months after a devastating Hamas-led attack on Israeli soil set off a relentless military campaign with few parallels in recent history.

In the attack that set it all in motion, the Oct. 7, 2023, raid on southern Israel led by Hamas fighters, some 1,200 people, most of them civilians, were killed, stunning Israelis. In the months that followed, an estimated 45,000 Palestinians in Gaza, many of them also civilians, were killed and entire towns leveled.

On Wednesday, Palestinians were allowing themselves to hope for an end to the long months of hunger, destruction, and fear, while Israelis were anxiously readying themselves to welcome home dozens of men and women taken hostage by Hamas during the 2023 attack.

Under the terms of the provisional deal, reached in the waning days of the Biden administration, the Israeli military will begin to pull back its force and Hamas will

CEASE-FIRE, Page A7



‘All living hostages need to be brought home immediately, **they are living in hell, in utter hell.** Their lives are in great danger. We know that.’

TAMAR DAVIS of Brookline, whose cousin Omer Neutra (seen in a poster at left), an Israeli American serving in the army there, was killed in the Oct. 7 attacks. His body hasn't been recovered. Locally, the cease-fire deal was met with relief. **B1.**

Another blow to red meat: study links it to dementia

By Kay Lazar

GLOBE STAFF

Regularly eating red meat has been linked with heart disease, diabetes, and several types of cancer. Now there's fresh evidence tying some popular types of red meat to yet another health concern: it could be bad for your brain.

A new study by Boston researchers finds that long-term consumption of processed red meat, such as hot dogs, sausage, and bacon, is linked to an elevated risk of dementia. The findings come on the heels of sobering research published on Monday from a separate team of sci-

entists that estimates the number of Americans who develop dementia each year will double by 2060, to roughly 1 million new cases a year, largely because of the aging population.

As scientists and policy makers search for ways to protect Americans' health — and stave off chronic illnesses— attention is increasingly turning to reforming the American diet.

In the meat study, published online Wednesday in the journal *Neurology*, researchers at Harvard's T.H. Chan School of Public Health and

PROCESSED FOOD, Page A6

Newton's mixed-level classes not closing achievement gap

By Christopher Huffaker

GLOBE STAFF

Four years ago, Newton sought to make its teaching instruction more inclusive, creating high school classrooms where students at different achievement levels could learn together, so that a child taking honors history might be seated next to a student taking standard history. Now, amid debate over whether this type of teaching works, a growing body of state data suggests the changes have done little to close achievement gaps between white and Asian students and Black and Latino students — but also do not appear to have made things worse.

The courses have come under fire from a group of teachers and parents who say they work for neither lower- nor higher-achieving students. Superintendent Anna Nolin said the district should have provided more training when the courses were rolled out in 2021 but vowed to complete an analysis of current systems before doing a broader overhaul of curriculum, assessments, and levels — with an eye toward a fall 2026 rollout.

With the district having failed to collect any data to measure the classes' impact, a Globe analysis shows the classes have not succeeded in bridging the

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